



MODULE 3

Interviewing the Interviewer

Turn the hot seat into a conversation. Walk in calm, take control of the room, and make the interviewer feel like they're already talking to a future colleague.

FRIDAY SESSION

June 26, 2026

LENGTH

1 hour

BUILDS ON

Modules 1 & 2 — the stacks

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most candidates wait to be interviewed. The good ones run a conversation.

For the last two Fridays you learned to **run a conversation** — the stacks, double-clicks, "and what else?", getting people to talk about themselves. An interview is just that conversation with a job at the end of it.

Here's the shift: the interviewer isn't only judging your answers. They're deciding whether they'd *enjoy sitting next to you*. The candidate who asks sharp questions and gets the interviewer talking doesn't feel like a candidate at all — they feel like a colleague who happens to be visiting. That's who gets the call back.

Think of the best conversation you had this week. What made it feel easy — and how could you bring that into a room where you're being judged?

evisions



MODULE 3

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*"People don't fall for the smartest person in the room.
They fall for the person who makes **them** feel smart."*

MODULE 3

What you'll walk away able to do

By the end of this hour you'll be able to steer an interview like one of your stack conversations — composed, curious, and in control.

1

Open with confidence

Run the First 90 Seconds — enter, smile, eye contact, use their name, and ask one question before you ever sit in the hot seat.

2

Make them feel smart

Use Module 1 skills on the interviewer: get them talking, double-click their answers, and become the most enjoyable conversation of their day.

3

Ask 8 questions that land

Have a pocket of questions ready that make you look thoughtful and reveal whether the job is actually right for you.

4

Close for next steps

End every interview by asking what happens next — and leave them wanting to see you again.

THE MINDSET

It's a conversation, not an interrogation

The same thing that made you likeable across a coffee table makes you hireable across a screen. Stop performing answers. Start having an exchange.

THE REFRAME

You are interviewing them as much as they are interviewing you. You're both trying to answer one question: **would we be glad to work together?** That posture takes the pressure off — and pressure is what makes people freeze.

When a candidate treats it as an interrogation, every answer is a defence. When they treat it as a conversation, they get curious, they listen, and they ask the question back. Watch how the same moment plays three ways:

AVOID

Interviewer: "So, tell me about yourself." **You:** recites résumé top to bottom, eyes down, no breath, no question back.

BETTER

A tight, confident summary — then it just stops. Accurate, but it lands like a statement read off a card. The room goes quiet.

IDEAL

A 60-second summary delivered warmly, then: *"...but I'd love to know how you ended up here first — what's your story with the team?"* Now you're two people talking.

THE OPENER

The First 90 Seconds

Interviewers form an impression before you've answered a single question. You don't get those 90 seconds back — so script them. Five moves, every time:

1

Enter confidently

Shoulders back, unhurried. On camera: sit up, fill the frame, look ready before they speak.

2

Smile

A real one. It tells their nervous system you're safe to talk to — and it relaxes you too.

3

Make eye contact

Look at the camera lens, not your own face in the corner. That's where the "eye contact" actually lands.

4

Use their name

"Great to meet you, Dana." Names signal warmth and confidence in one beat.

5

Ask one question immediately

Before you settle into being asked things, ask something first. You set the tone as a conversation.

WHAT THE OPENER BUYS YOU

In one breath you've shown up calm, warm, and proactive — and you've nudged the room from "examination" toward "chat." Everything after this is easier.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The opener, out loud

Here's the First 90 Seconds doing its job. Notice the candidate asks before being asked — and then **double-clicks** the answer, straight out of Module 1.

INTERVIEWER

Hi — come on in. Did you find us okay?

YOU

I did, thanks Dana — great to finally meet you. Before we dive into me, I have to ask: how did *you* end up on this team?

INTERVIEWER

Ha — happily ambushed. I actually started in support and moved over two years ago...

YOU

Support to this team — what made you want to make that jump?

INTERVIEWER

Honestly? The people. Let me tell you about the day I decided...

NOTICE

Five seconds in, the interviewer is telling *you* a story. You used their name, asked one question immediately, then double-clicked "support" and "jump." The interview is already a conversation — and it was your move that made it one.

THE PRINCIPLE

Make them feel smart

THE WHOLE MODULE IN ONE LINE

People like the candidate who makes them feel smart. Not the one who proves how smart *they* are.

You can't make someone feel smart by talking. You do it by **asking good questions and then actually listening** — the exact skill from Module 1. When you ask a sharp question, the interviewer gets to be the expert, the insider, the one with the good story. People love being that person. They walk away thinking "*that was a great conversation*" — and they mean *they* were great in it.

This is how you win, not how you trick

Making someone feel smart isn't flattery. It's genuine interest pointed at them instead of at yourself. The skills carry straight over: open-ended questions, double-clicks, "and what else?", and the pause.

The signal you're doing it right

The interviewer is talking more than you are, leaning in, and losing track of time. That's not you dodging the interview — that's you *winning* it.

Write one question you could ask any interviewer that would make them the expert for the next two minutes.

YOUR POCKET

8 questions to ask the interviewer

Keep these in your back pocket. You won't use all eight — pick the ones the moment opens up for. Each one gets them talking and tells you something you actually want to know.

1

How did you get started here?

Their origin story. Easy to answer, gets them talking, and instantly builds rapport — your opener question.

2

What do you enjoy most about working here?

Lets them be positive and personal. Their answer tells you what the culture actually rewards.

3

What separates your top performers from everyone else?

Flattering to answer and pure gold — it's a roadmap to exactly what they want from this role.

4

What are the biggest challenges facing the team right now?

Shows you think like a teammate, not a tourist. Their answer is your interview prep for the rest of the conversation.

YOUR POCKET

8 questions, continued

5

What does success look like in the first 90 days?

Signals you're already picturing the job. The answer is, almost literally, your future to-do list.

6

How has this role changed since you've been here?

Invites a story and reveals whether the team is growing, firefighting, or standing still.

7

What's the team most excited about right now?

Ends the exchange on energy. People remember how you made them feel — leave them feeling good.

8

What are the next steps from here?

The close. Always ask. It shows interest, gives you a timeline, and ends the meeting on *your* initiative.

CLOSING MOVE

Never leave without question 8. "What are the next steps?" turns a polite goodbye into a real one — and the last thing they remember is a candidate who was already moving forward.

PRACTICE

Breakout: get them talking for 5 minutes

Pair up. One of you is the interviewer, one is the candidate. The candidate has one job: **get the interviewer talking for five straight minutes** — using only questions and the listening skills from Module 1. Then swap.

- 1 Open with the First 90 Seconds — name, smile, one question immediately.
- 2 Pull from your 8 questions. Don't fire them like a list — double-click the answers.
- 3 Your goal isn't to talk. It's to make *them* the most interesting person in the room.
- 4 If they go quiet, "and what else?" or "tell me more about that."

DEBRIEF — MAKE NOTES FOR THE GROUP

Which questions got your interviewer talking the most?

Where did the conversation come alive — and where did it stall?

APPLY THIS WEEK

Apply this week

Skills don't stick in the room — they stick in reps. Three small ones before Friday:

1

Run the opener on a real human

This week, walk into one conversation — a meeting, a coffee, a call — and run the First 90 Seconds: smile, name, one question first. Notice how the room changes.

2

Build your pocket

Write your own version of the 8 questions in your words. Pick the three you'd actually say out loud and memorize them.

3

Make one person feel smart

Pick someone and, for one conversation, make it your only mission to make them the expert. Ask, double-click, and shut up. Watch what happens.

Next Friday we go from asking the questions to answering them — Thinking on Your Feet. Jot one interview question that scares you, so we can take it apart together.
